

Ricardo Montano

Santa Ana, CA || (714) 342-0059 || rickymont2005@gmail.com || [linkedin.com/in/rickymont2005](https://www.linkedin.com/in/rickymont2005)

EDUCATION

University of California, Irvine

Bachelor of Science, Mechanical Engineering

Dean's Honor List (2x)

Expected Graduation: June 2027

Cumulative GPA: 3.20

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Distribution Systems International - Product & Design Engineering Intern

June 2026 - Present

- Designed and improved hardware for modular hospital-storage products, applying GD&T and dimensional tolerancing to production drawings and translating design changes into manufacturable SolidWorks models
- Revised 30+ engineering drawings and modeled 40+ components and assemblies in SolidWorks; maintained bills of materials and manufacturing documentation supporting fabrication, assembly, and product configuration
- Performed dimensional inspections, fit checks, and functional testing on parts and assemblies; used findings to diagnose fit issues and drive hardware revisions
- Developed early-stage product concepts to improve shelving stability for heavier load applications, including designs intended to support loads of up to 200+ lbs
- Exported SolidWorks assemblies into Revit-compatible formats and produced 10+ customer-facing layouts, demonstrating product configurations and equipment placement

UCI RC Plane Project - Assembly & Systems Team Member

May 2026 - Present

- Produced over 30 flight-ready components while maintaining dimensional accuracy during assembly
- Assembled fuselage and wing sections by fitting, aligning, and bonding printed parts
- Integrated 2 motors and 3 servos into the aircraft during assembly

UCI Autonomous Robot Project – Controls & Fabrication Engineer

April 2026 - June 2026

- Designed and tuned autonomous control software for a competition robot, reducing run time by 15 seconds through calibration-based motion improvements
- Built calibration routines to improve repeatability, sensor accuracy, and autonomous path execution
- Assisted with fabrication and hardware integration, bridging mechanical and electrical design with controls implementation

Level 1 High-Power Rocket - Design & Fabrication Engineer

January 2026 - April 2026

- Designed a Level 1 certification rocket using SolidWorks CAD and OpenRocket simulation to iterate geometry and assess stability/performance prior to fabrication
- Fabricated precision fin components using laser cutting and integrated them into the airframe with careful attention to alignment and structural fitment
- 3D-printed a custom nose cone on a Bambu Lab printer, validated tolerance to fit the airframe and incorporated iteration based on assembly results to improve reliability
- Achieved Rocket Certification (NAR/Tripoli) w/ an apogee of 900m, max velocity of 228m/s, stability of 1.3

WORK EXPERIENCE

Santa Ana Unified School District - Academic Tutor

September 2023 - Present

- Tutor underprivileged high school students in rigorous AP classes, helping improve their grades and understanding by simplifying complex concepts
- Developed lesson plans, study habits, and reinforcing problem-solving skills for students

Fisher Phillips LLP - Summer Intern

June 2022 – August 2022

- Supported legal staff with documentation, organization, and client communication by drafting and formatting documents in Microsoft Word, managing case files in Excel, coordinating correspondences through Outlook, maintaining and organizing digital records in the firm's case management systems.

SKILLS

Engineering: SolidWorks, AutoCAD, Revit, FEA, MATLAB, Simulink, engineering drawings, GD&T

Manufacturing: BOMs, manufacturing planning, dimensional inspection, testing, 3D Printing, laser cutting, hand tools

Programming: Arduino, C++, Python | **Languages:** Fluent English and Spanish (Gold Seal of Biliteracy)